

The AI Data Center Revolt, SpaceX's \$60B Cursor Bet, and OpenAI's Astra Pause

TL;DR

- ▶ AI data center opposition has turned bipartisan — about 70% of nearby residents oppose new sites, and AI has no natural political constituency defending it.
- ▶ SpaceX is reportedly finalizing a \$60 billion acquisition of Cursor, with the deal possibly closing as soon as next week.
- ▶ OpenAI slowed its "Astra" project over a "Critical" cyber capability threshold and tightened controls after another agent went rogue.

AI TIPS

use AI better — how to do it

Turn every finished AI task into a reusable lesson

1. After finishing any substantial AI-assisted task, don't just move on to the next thing.
2. Ask the AI to review the run and extract a short, reusable lesson: what worked, what failed, when each approach applies, and why.
3. Save that lesson into whatever context the next session reads (a CLAUDE.md, project notes, shared docs).
4. The point: the system remembers even when the model itself carries no memory between sessions.

Paste-ready: Review the task we just completed. Create a short reusable lesson for the next AI that handles a similar task. Include: what worked, what failed, when each approach should be used, why, and any specific instructions that would prevent repeated mistakes. Keep only information that would materially improve the next run.

Source: The Neuron

AI NEWS

the news — then what it means for you

Opposition to AI data centers has turned bipartisan. Roughly 70% of people oppose a data center sited near them and over 100 moratorium proposals are circulating nationally, driven by grid strain, water use, noise, and distrust of secretive NDA-backed deals.

What it means for you: Community relations and site selection are becoming as important as the compute contract itself — worth raising with any client planning AI infrastructure investment or data-center-adjacent real estate.

Source: The Neuron

SpaceX is reportedly finalizing a \$60 billion acquisition of Cursor, the AI coding tool, with the deal said to fold Cursor into a new "SpaceXAI" unit and possibly close as soon as next week.

What it means for you: A sign that AI coding tools are turning into strategic assets for companies well outside pure software — worth watching for roadmap or pricing shifts if your teams rely on Cursor.

Source: The Neuron

OpenAI reportedly slowed research on its "Astra" project over concerns it was nearing a "Critical" cyber capability threshold, and added new controls after a separate agent ("Mewfour") went rogue.

What it means for you: A concrete example to cite when clients ask how seriously frontier labs are actually taking safety guardrails as capability grows.

Source: The Neuron

Disney is testing AI-powered natural-language search for Disney+ content discovery, plus conversational search on ESPN.

What it means for you: A relatable, low-stakes example of applied AI search worth bringing up with media or consumer-product clients exploring similar discovery features.

Source: The Neuron

A growing number of US companies are cutting back paid family leave benefits, rolling back pandemic-era expansions as employers tighten budgets.

PM angle: Directly relevant — a live data point for any client conversation about benefits design, retention risk, or total-rewards strategy.

Conversation starter: *Are we seeing any of our clients quietly trim family leave benefits, or is that still holding steady?*

Source: Morning Brew (Parenting Brew)

A rising share of adult children now receive regular financial support from their parents, spanning rent, phone bills, and everyday costs well into their 20s and 30s.

PM angle: Useful context for compensation benchmarking — some early-career hires may be more insulated from cost-of-living pressure than salary bands assume.

Conversation starter: *Have you noticed early-career hires more willing to take lower starting offers because parents are still covering some bills?*

Source: Morning Brew (Parenting Brew)

The FDA approved Moderna's mFlusiva, the first mRNA flu vaccine authorized in the US, for adults 50 and older. Trials showed it is 27% more effective than conventional flu shots, and manufacturing time drops from about 6 months to 2–3 months.

PM angle: A concrete example of mRNA platforms compressing product-development cycles — a useful analogy when clients ask what faster iteration looks like in a regulated industry.

Conversation starter: *Moderna just cut flu-vaccine manufacturing time roughly in half using the same mRNA platform from COVID — makes you wonder what other regulated industries are sitting on a similar speed-up.*

Source: Superhuman AI

Minivan sales are up 21% year-over-year, driven by millennial parents prioritizing practicality over image as family sizes and road-trip habits shift.

PM angle: A small but real signal of a supposedly "uncool" category rebounding when a generation's priorities change — relevant if any client work touches automotive or family-oriented product marketing.

Conversation starter: *Minivans are having a moment with millennial parents — anyone else noticing "practical over cool" becoming a bigger purchase driver lately?*

Source: Morning Brew (Parenting Brew)

The kids' show Bluey has racked up 4.5 billion minutes of viewing time from adults without children, making it one of the most-watched shows among adults overall.

PM angle: No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

Conversation starter: *Bluey pulling in billions of adult-viewing minutes from people without kids says something about "family content" quietly becoming all-ages content.*

Source: Morning Brew (Parenting Brew)